

Are expensive batteries worth it?

An interesting study of whether buying expensive batteries actually makes a difference and if they're worth the buck
<http://bit.ly/xuSzie>

Hexplane – An aircraft?

The guys at Oliver VTOL plan to make a six-engine airliner-helicopter hybrid
<http://bit.ly/zsUWdm>

MF-3010 has a flat front with two glossy side strips and a glossy control panel. And since it has a flat front it's very difficult to see the control panel unless it is kept at chest height. The Canon MF4420w, on the other hand, has a protruding control panel and output tray. The Panasonic KX-MB1520 SX MFD, too, comes in a completely black body. Giving it an edge over Canon is its non-protruding output tray or control panel. The control panel has been designed with a slightly slanted profile, not only making it easy to see but also making it easy to use. The only glitch in Panasonic's MFD design is it doesn't really come with a paper stopper so prints tend to fall off.

The two Brother MFDs, MFC-7360 and MFC-7860DW have a completely identical design. The former has a completely off-white body with only the manual feed slot in a grey shade, whereas, the latter has a black body with only the manual feed slot in a glossy finish. The control panel on both of the Brother MFDs has been designed with a slanted profile, making it very easy to see and use. The Brother DCP-7065DN, is a very similar design to these two Brother products, but doesn't provide fax support. This change is reflected in the control panel which has fewer function buttons.

The HP Laserjet Pro M1213NF MFP, the Epson

AcuLaser CX17NF and the AcuLaser MX14 were the biggest and bulkiest of the entire lot. The Epson CX17NF and the MX14 were the only two LED MFDs we received and they were well-designed as well. Instead of the standard protruding output trays they both have an inner output tray. The only sad part is that they both have a corporate feel to them, with completely off-white bodies. The HP Laserjet Pro M1213NF MFP, despite having a completely black body, still has a corporate ring to it. These models feel like they've been specifically designed keeping small offices in mind.

We were eager to test the Dell MFD out. The Dell 1135n does look like it's designed to offer compactness. It's the only other MFD with ADF support that really comes close to the compactness of the two Brother MFDs mentioned earlier.

Build

Only a handful of MFDs seemed to have really paid any attention to their build. It was very disappointing – either the input or output tray was flimsily built, the scanner top was poorly made, or the ADF slot was rickety. None of the MFDs we received came with an all-round stand-out build. However, of the entire lot, the Brother DCP-7065DN put together the best. Its scanner flap is the



Epson AcuLaser MX14: A value for money LED MFD

least flimsy among the competition. The input and output tray are well made. Sadly only the ADF slot lacked a little in comparison.

The other MFDs that managed to deliver decent build are Epson MX14, Canon imageClass MF-3010, Dell 1135n, Brother DCP-7055, Brother MFC-7360 and Brother DCP-7860DW. The Canon imageClass MF-3010 has an ultra-sturdy body, but we noticed a slight flimsiness with its input tray. The Panasonic KX-MB1520 had the worst build of the lot with an extremely flimsy scanner flap and a very poorly built tray.

Stand-out features and Control Panel

Most of the laser MFDs are targeted at small offices or home offices and these MFDs are especially tuned towards print jobs. They're expected to throw

out good quality prints while being fast. These MFDs will print superb quality text and mixed documents as compared to the inkjet MFDs. They, however, don't have a lot of features to highlight apart from their standard print, copy, scan and fax functions.



Dell 1135n: A feature packed yet compact MFD

HP Laserjet Pro M1213NF MFP is no different. It gives you a complete command over the print settings right from the control panel itself. Using the control panel you can give a copy command, set the number of prints required, increase or decrease the size of the print,

TCO

Though the MFDs have become cheap to buy, the price of cartridges increase the running cost of your MFD. Before buying a MFD, based upon your usage, calculate a rough cost of owning the printer for a minimum of three years. Some MFDs might have a very high initial cost but it might give you the best value for money over a period three years as compared to a budget MFD, which has a low initial cost, but run a high running cost for the subsequent years.